

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Union and Territory - Solved Practice Workbook

Standalone solved workbook | 32 original MCQs | verified PYQs | six Mains models

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

Union and Territory - Solved Practice Workbook	4
BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION	4
Q1. Article 1(1) primarily settles which two issues together?	4
Q2. Which statement best captures the difference between the Union of India and the Territory of India?	4
Q3. Article 2 is conceptually different from Article 3 because Article 2 deals with	4
Q4. Which one of the following is NOT one of the express Article 3 operations?	5
Q5. Before an Article 3 bill is introduced in Parliament, what is constitutionally necessary?	5
Q6. The legislature of the affected State, when consulted under Article 3, has	5
Q7. Explanation I to Article 3 matters because it states that	5
Q8. Article 4 keeps reorganisation laws outside Article 368 because such laws are	6
Q9. The First Schedule is constitutionally important because it	6
Q10. Which one of the following most accurately states Berubari Union (1960)?	6
Q11. The Supreme Court's 1969 boundary-settlement ruling is mainly remembered for holding that	6
Q12. Which constitutional amendment implemented the India-Bangladesh enclave exchange and related territorial adjustments?	7
Q13. Which sequence is correct for the linguistic-reorganisation debate?	7
Q14. What was the decisive political trigger for the creation of Andhra State in 1953?	7
Q15. The States Reorganisation Act, 1956 together with the Seventh Amendment created	7
Q16. Which one of the following pairs is correctly matched?	8
Q17. The present practical count of Union Territories as of 7 Sep 2026 is	8
Q18. Which sequence of Statehood is correct?	8
Q19. Which one of the following correctly describes the 1950 map?	8
Q20. Sikkim's constitutional sequence was	9
Q21. With reference to the India-Bangladesh Land Boundary Agreement, which is correct?	9
Q22. On the official record located through 7 September 2026, the correct J&K position is	9
Q23. In the 2023 Article 370 judgment, the Supreme Court	9
Q24. Which criterion set is most defensible for evaluating a smaller-State demand?	10
Q25. Which one of the following is correctly matched?	10
Q26. The enacted result of the 1956 settlement was	10

Q27. Which statement is correct about Ladakh's current demand?	10
Q28. Which statement best explains why Article 3 is often cited as proof of India's strong-Centre bias?	11
Q29. Article 4 expressly enables a law under Articles 2 or 3 to amend which Schedules as necessary?	11
Q30. Parliament materially amends an Article 3 Bill after the affected State legislature has sent its views. Which statement is correct?	11
Q31. Historical polity texts list conquest among modes of territorial acquisition. A current answer should add that	11
Q32. State of West Bengal v. Union of India is relevant to this topic chiefly because it	12

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE 12

Audited ownership and key discipline	12
PYQ 1. Prelims 2025, GS Paper I, Question 52 - verbatim official-paper verification	12
PYQ 2. Mains 2018, GS Paper I, Question 12 - owner-verified exact text	13
PYQ 3. Mains 2022, GS Paper I, Question 11 - owner-verified exact text	13
Six original Mains questions with complete model solutions	14
Original Mains model 1 - 10 marks: Distinguish the 'Territory of India' from the 'Union of India'. Why does the distinction matter?	14
Original Mains model 2 - 10 marks: Distinguish cession of Indian territory from settlement of a boundary dispute.	14
Original Mains model 3 - 15 marks: 'India is an indestructible Union of destructible States.' Examine with special reference to Article 3.	15
Original Mains model 4 - 15 marks: Demands for smaller States should be decided through governance criteria, not identity alone. Discuss.	15
Original Mains model 5 - 20 marks: Linguistic reorganisation strengthened rather than weakened the Indian Union. Critically examine.	15
Original Mains model 6 - 20 marks: Does Article 3 reconcile national unity with democratic consent, or does it privilege unity at the expense of federal trust? Critically examine.	16

Union and Territory - Solved Practice Workbook

Boundary: Articles 1-4, territory of India, admission/establishment and State reorganisation. Detailed Union Territory administration remains with Polity Topic 25.

Exactly **32 original MCQs** precede the PYQ block. Keys rotate ABCDABCDABCDABCDABCDABCDABCDABCD. Every option has a question-specific substantive explanation; every item ends with a distinct examiner trap.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Article 1(1) primarily settles which two issues together?

A. The country's name and the type of polity B. The capital city and the official language C. The citizenship rules and the anthem D. The emergency powers and amendment process

Answer: A.

- **A:** Correct: Article 1(1) joins the constitutional name 'India, that is Bharat' to the description 'Union of States'.
- **B:** Capitals and official languages are supplied through other constitutional or statutory arrangements, not Article 1(1).
- **C:** Citizenship begins in Part II, while national-symbol status is not the paired subject of Article 1.
- **D:** Emergency and amendment powers belong principally to Parts XVIII and XX, not the opening territorial clause.

Examiner trap: Article 1 tests two linked ideas-name and polity-not a miscellaneous pair of national facts.

Q2. Which statement best captures the difference between the Union of India and the Territory of India?

A. The Union of India includes only Parliament, while the Territory of India includes Parliament and the States B. The Union of India refers to the States as federal members, while the Territory of India also includes Union Territories and acquired territories C. The Union of India means the Union executive, while the Territory of India means the Union judiciary D. The two expressions are exact constitutional synonyms

Answer: B.

- **A:** Parliament is an institution; the expression 'Union of India' here identifies the State-members of the federation, not Parliament alone.
- **B:** Correct: the territory of India adds Union Territories and acquired territories to the territories of the States.
- **C:** The distinction concerns federal membership and territorial reach, not a division between executive and judiciary.
- **D:** Article 1(3)'s three-part enumeration prevents the two expressions from being exact synonyms.

Examiner trap: Membership of the federation and reach of Indian sovereignty are overlapping but unequal sets.

Q3. Article 2 is conceptually different from Article 3 because Article 2 deals with

A. renaming existing States B. creation of legislative councils in States C. admission into the Union or establishment of new States not already part of the existing Union D. cession of Indian territory to a foreign State

Answer: C.

- **A:** Renaming an existing State is expressly an Article 3(e) operation.
- **B:** Legislative councils are governed by Article 169, not the admission power.
- **C:** Correct: Article 2 addresses admission into the Union or establishment of new States, conventionally contrasted with Article 3's internal reorganisation.
- **D:** Foreign cession is controlled by Article 368 after *Berubari*, not by Article 2.

Examiner trap: Use the Constitution's verbs before relying on the convenient 'outside/inside' mnemonic.

Q4. Which one of the following is NOT one of the express Article 3 operations?

A. Increasing the area of a State B. Altering the name of a State C. Altering the boundaries of a State D. Ceding accepted Indian territory to a foreign State

Answer: D.

- **A:** Increasing State area is expressly listed in Article 3(b).
- **B:** Changing a State's name is expressly authorised by Article 3(e).
- **C:** Altering State boundaries falls within Article 3(d).
- **D:** Correct: surrender of accepted Indian territory abroad is cession and lies outside Article 3.

Examiner trap: A power to diminish State area is not a power to diminish Indian sovereignty abroad.

Q5. Before an Article 3 bill is introduced in Parliament, what is constitutionally necessary?

A. The prior recommendation of the President B. Prior ratification by at least half the States C. A joint sitting of both Houses D. Approval by the Supreme Court under Article 143

Answer: A.

- **A:** Correct: presidential recommendation is a condition before introduction of an Article 3 Bill.
- **B:** Half-State ratification belongs to specified Article 368 amendments, not territorial reorganisation under Article 3.
- **C:** A joint sitting is neither an introduction condition nor the ordinary mechanism for such a Bill.
- **D:** Article 143 advisory jurisdiction does not replace the President's Article 3 recommendation.

Examiner trap: Do not import Article 368 ratification or Article 143 review into Article 3's introduction stage.

Q6. The legislature of the affected State, when consulted under Article 3, has

A. a suspensive veto that can be overridden only in a joint sitting B. a right to express its views, but no veto over Parliament's final decision C. a binding veto unless the Supreme Court permits otherwise D. a co-equal decision-making role with Parliament

Answer: B.

- **A:** The State legislature has no suspensive veto under the proviso.
- **B:** Correct: it may communicate views, but Parliament may accept, reject or depart from them.
- **C:** Neither State consent nor Supreme Court permission is constitutionally required.
- **D:** Final law-making authority remains with Parliament; the affected legislature is consultative.

Examiner trap: Reference creates a hearing, not a veto; 'consulted' is not 'consenting'.

Q7. Explanation I to Article 3 matters because it states that

A. Union Territories are treated as States for all constitutional purposes B. States and UTs have identical representation in Rajya Sabha C. for clauses (a) to (e), 'State' includes a Union Territory, but not in the proviso requiring legislature-reference D. the President may abolish a State by ordinance

Answer: C.

- **A:** Explanation I does not make Union Territories States for every constitutional purpose.
- **B:** Rajya Sabha representation is governed separately, including by the Fourth Schedule.
- **C:** Correct: inclusion applies to clauses (a)-(e), while the proviso's legislature-reference excludes a Union Territory.
- **D:** Nothing in Explanation I creates an ordinance power to abolish States.

Examiner trap: Explanation I changes meaning between the substantive clauses and the proviso.

Q8. Article 4 keeps reorganisation laws outside Article 368 because such laws are

- A. automatically approved by the Supreme Court B. valid only for five years unless renewed C. treated as Money Bills
D. not deemed constitutional amendments for the purposes of Article 368

Answer: D.

- **A:** Judicial approval is not what removes these laws from Article 368.
- **B:** Article 4 laws do not lapse after five years.
- **C:** Territorial reorganisation Bills are not converted into Money Bills.
- **D:** Correct: Article 4(2) expressly says they are not deemed constitutional amendments for Article 368.

Examiner trap: Ordinary voting threshold does not make territorial legislation constitutionally trivial.

Q9. The First Schedule is constitutionally important because it

- A. lists the States and Union Territories and their territorial extent B. contains the amendment procedure C. allocates Lok Sabha seats among constituencies D. lists the official languages of every State

Answer: A.

- **A:** Correct: the First Schedule identifies States and Union Territories and describes their territories.
- **B:** The amendment procedure is contained in Article 368.
- **C:** Constituency allocation and delimitation are not the First Schedule's central function.
- **D:** Official languages are principally addressed in Part XVII and the Eighth Schedule.

Examiner trap: First Schedule is territorial; Fourth Schedule is Rajya Sabha; Seventh Schedule distributes subjects.

Q10. Which one of the following most accurately states *Berubari Union (1960)*?

- A. Any change in a State boundary requires prior consent of that State B. Cession of accepted Indian territory to a foreign State requires a constitutional amendment C. No Indian territory can ever be ceded under the Constitution D. Parliament cannot alter a State's name without Article 368

Answer: B.

- **A:** *Berubari* did not create a State-consent requirement for internal boundary changes.
- **B:** Correct: ceding territory India accepts as its own requires constitutional amendment under Article 368.
- **C:** The Court did not hold that cession was constitutionally impossible; it identified the valid route.
- **D:** State renaming remains possible by Article 3(e) read with Article 4.

Examiner trap: *Berubari* prescribes the route for cession; it does not constitutionally freeze every border.

Q11. The Supreme Court's 1969 boundary-settlement ruling is mainly remembered for holding that

- A. every international boundary issue must be referred under Article 143 B. the Union cannot acquire State property
C. boundary settlement or ascertainment without cession does not automatically require Article 368 D. Article 3 and Article 4 are unconstitutional

Answer: C.

- **A:** Article 143 reference is not compulsory for every boundary agreement.
- **B:** The case was not a ruling on Union acquisition of State property.
- **C:** Correct: genuine ascertainment or implementation of a disputed boundary may proceed without Article 368 because no accepted Indian territory is ceded.
- **D:** The judgment did not invalidate Articles 3 or 4.

Examiner trap: Ask whether title is surrendered or an uncertain line is merely identified.

Q12. Which constitutional amendment implemented the India-Bangladesh enclave exchange and related territorial adjustments?

A. The Ninth Constitutional Amendment Act, 1960 B. The Seventh Constitutional Amendment Act, 1956 C. The Thirty-Sixth Constitutional Amendment Act, 1975 D. The 100th Constitutional Amendment Act, 2015

Answer: D.

- **A:** The Ninth Amendment supplied the route for the earlier India-Pakistan Berubari arrangement, not the 2015 enclave exchange.
- **B:** The Seventh Amendment accompanied the 1956 internal reorganisation.
- **C:** The Thirty-Sixth Amendment made Sikkim a full State in 1975.
- **D:** Correct: the 100th Amendment implemented the India-Bangladesh Land Boundary Agreement framework and changed relevant First Schedule entries.

Examiner trap: Ninth Amendment and 100th Amendment concern different India-Pakistan/Bangladesh territorial settlements.

Q13. Which sequence is correct for the linguistic-reorganisation debate?

A. Dhar Commission -> JVP Committee -> Andhra State -> Fazl Ali / SRC -> States Reorganisation Act B. JVP Committee -> Dhar Commission -> Fazl Ali / SRC -> Andhra State -> Seventh Amendment C. Andhra State -> Dhar Commission -> JVP Committee -> Fazl Ali / SRC -> States Reorganisation Act D. Fazl Ali / SRC -> Dhar Commission -> JVP Committee -> Andhra State -> States Reorganisation Act

Answer: A.

- **A:** Correct: Dhar preceded JVP; Andhra came in 1953; the SRC followed; the 1956 Act implemented the settlement.
- **B:** This wrongly places JVP before Dhar and the SRC before Andhra.
- **C:** Andhra cannot precede the 1948 Dhar and 1949 JVP stages.
- **D:** The Fazl Ali Commission was the later response, not the opening event.

Examiner trap: Chronology is the elimination tool: Dhar -> JVP -> Andhra -> Fazl Ali/SRC -> 1956.

Q14. What was the decisive political trigger for the creation of Andhra State in 1953?

A. A Presidential reference under Article 143 B. The prolonged fast and death of Potti Sriramulu C. The demand of the JVP Committee D. The Ninth Amendment Act

Answer: B.

- **A:** No Article 143 reference caused Andhra State's creation.
- **B:** Correct: Potti Sriramulu's fast and death generated the decisive political pressure for Andhra in 1953.
- **C:** The JVP Committee had resisted immediate linguistic reorganisation rather than demanded Andhra.
- **D:** The Ninth Amendment concerned foreign territorial cession, not Andhra.

Examiner trap: The political catalyst and the later legal instrument are related but not identical.

Q15. The States Reorganisation Act, 1956 together with the Seventh Amendment created

A. 16 States and 3 Union Territories exactly as originally recommended by the SRC B. 28 States and 8 Union Territories C. 14 States and 6 Union Territories D. 15 States and 5 Union Territories

Answer: C.

- **A:** The enacted 1956 settlement did not produce 16 States and 3 UTs.
- **B:** The familiar constitutional count is not 15 and 7.
- **C:** Correct: the States Reorganisation Act and Seventh Amendment produced 14 States and 6 Union Territories on 1 November 1956.
- **D:** The Part A-B-C-D categories were abolished rather than retained with 27 States.

Examiner trap: The exact 1956 output is a favourite count trap: 14 States and 6 UTs.

Q16. Which one of the following pairs is correctly matched?

A. Nagaland - Statehood through the Ninth Amendment B. Goa - Statehood through the 100th Amendment C. Telangana - created by the Seventh Amendment D. Sikkim - full Statehood through the 36th Amendment after the brief associate-State experiment

Answer: D.

- **A:** Nagaland became a State in 1963 through the State of Nagaland Act, accompanied by the Thirteenth Amendment; the Ninth Amendment concerned territorial cession.
- **B:** Goa attained Statehood in 1987; the 100th Amendment dealt with the India-Bangladesh land-boundary settlement.
- **C:** Telangana was created under the Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation Act, 2014, not the Seventh Amendment.
- **D:** Correct: the 36th Amendment made Sikkim a full State in 1975 after its brief associate-State arrangement under the 35th Amendment.

Examiner trap: Formation dates and later State-number labels should not be mixed.

Q17. The present practical count of Union Territories as of 7 Sep 2026 is

A. 8 B. 6 C. 7 D. 9

Answer: A.

- **A:** Correct: after the 26 January 2020 merger of Dadra and Nagar Haveli with Daman and Diu, India has eight Union Territories.
- **B:** Six was the Union Territory count produced by the 1956 settlement, not the current count.
- **C:** Seven understates the operative First Schedule list by one.
- **D:** Nine was the short-lived count after the J&K reorganisation and before the 2020 merger.

Examiner trap: Always date the count: 9 UTs briefly existed after 31 October 2019; 8 after 26 January 2020.

Q18. Which sequence of Statehood is correct?

A. Arunachal Pradesh 1963; Nagaland 1972; Tripura 1987 B. Nagaland 1963; Tripura 1972; Arunachal Pradesh 1987 C. Tripura 1963; Arunachal Pradesh 1972; Nagaland 1987 D. Nagaland, Tripura and Arunachal Pradesh all in 1972

Answer: B.

- **A:** Arunachal Pradesh did not become a State before Tripura.
- **B:** Correct: Nagaland (1963) preceded Tripura (1972), which preceded Arunachal Pradesh (1987).
- **C:** Tripura did not precede Nagaland's 1963 Statehood.
- **D:** This reverses both Nagaland-Tripura and Tripura-Arunachal chronology.

Examiner trap: UPSC's 2025 triad turns on 1963, 1972 and 1987.

Q19. Which one of the following correctly describes the 1950 map?

A. Manipur and Tripura were Part B States B. Delhi was the sole Part D territory C. Part A had 9 units, Part B 9, Part C 10, and Andaman and Nicobar Islands alone formed Part D D. Hyderabad was a Part A State

Answer: C.

- **A:** Part A units were former Governors' Provinces, not all princely unions.
- **B:** Part B included major former princely units; it was not limited to centrally administered territories.
- **C:** Correct: the commencement map comprised 9 Part A, 9 Part B, 10 Part C units and the sole Part D territory, Andaman and Nicobar Islands.
- **D:** Manipur and Tripura were Part C units, not Part D.

Examiner trap: Part C and Part D were not synonyms; Andaman and Nicobar Islands alone formed Part D.

Q20. Sikkim's constitutional sequence was

A. full Statehood in 1974 followed by associate status in 1975 B. UT status under the Seventh Amendment followed by Article 3 Statehood C. associate status under the 36th Amendment followed by Statehood under the 35th D. associate-State status through the 35th Amendment in 1974, followed by full Statehood through the 36th Amendment in 1975

Answer: D.

- **A:** Sikkim was not admitted directly as a full State in 1950.
- **B:** The 35th and 36th Amendments, not the 7th and 9th, control Sikkim's sequence.
- **C:** There was an associate-State stage before full Statehood.
- **D:** Correct: the 35th Amendment created associate status in 1974; the 36th Amendment made Sikkim a State in 1975 and removed the temporary arrangement.

Examiner trap: Sikkim's short associate-State phase is the close-option hinge.

Q21. With reference to the India-Bangladesh Land Boundary Agreement, which is correct?

A. The 100th Amendment implemented an exchange in which India transferred 111 enclaves and received 51 B. India transferred 51 enclaves and received 111 under the Ninth Amendment alone C. The First Schedule did not require amendment D. Only West Bengal's territorial entry was affected

Answer: A.

- **A:** Correct: the 100th Amendment implemented the LBA framework; India transferred 111 enclaves and received 51.
- **B:** This reverses the enclave figures and wrongly treats the Ninth Amendment as the complete 2015 route.
- **C:** The constitutional exchange required changes to First Schedule territorial descriptions.
- **D:** Assam, West Bengal, Meghalaya and Tripura were involved; the amendment was not confined to West Bengal.

Examiner trap: Enclave numbers run in opposite directions: India transferred 111 and received 51.

Q22. On the official record located through 7 September 2026, the correct J&K position is

A. Statehood was automatically restored by the 2023 judgment B. J&K remains a UT with Legislature; restoration was directed and assured but had not been legally completed C. J&K and Ladakh have recombined into a State D. Ladakh is a State without Legislature

Answer: B.

- **A:** The 2023 judgment urged early restoration but did not itself convert J&K into a State.
- **B:** Correct: the operative position checked through 7 September 2026 remains J&K as a UT with Legislature, with restoration not yet completed by operative law.
- **C:** The 2019 creation of two UTs has not been reversed by a recombination law.
- **D:** Ladakh remains a Union Territory without Legislature, not a State.

Examiner trap: Judicial direction or political assurance is not an appointed-day notification.

Q23. In the 2023 Article 370 judgment, the Supreme Court

A. held every whole-State-to-UT conversion valid B. restored J&K Statehood with immediate effect C. upheld carving out Ladakh, treated State views as recommendatory, but did not finally decide the broader whole-State-to-UT issue because of the restoration assurance D. held Article 3 inapplicable to Union Territories

Answer: C.

- **A:** The Court did not hold all State-to-UT conversion categorically unconstitutional.
- **B:** It did not restore J&K Statehood by judicial decree on judgment day.
- **C:** Correct: it upheld Ladakh's carving under Article 3 and left the broader whole-State conversion issue unresolved in light of the restoration assurance.
- **D:** It did not convert State-legislature views into a binding veto.

Examiner trap: The 2023 judgment's narrow Ladakh holding must not be expanded into a universal conversion rule.

Q24. Which criterion set is most defensible for evaluating a smaller-State demand?

A. Population and language alone B. Political mobilisation alone C. Consent of the parent State alone D. Administrative access, fiscal viability, transition costs, resource division, minority safeguards, democratic support and inter-State effects

Answer: D.

- **A:** Identity alone cannot test fiscal or institutional viability.
- **B:** Population and area alone omit administration, resources, minorities and transition.
- **C:** Party advantage is constitutionally and analytically inadequate.
- **D:** Correct: democratic support, access, fiscal capacity, assets, minorities, security and alternatives form a defensible decision matrix.

Examiner trap: A Statehood demand needs both democratic legitimacy and a workable institutional transition.

Q25. Which one of the following is correctly matched?

A. United Provinces -> Uttar Pradesh, 1950 B. Mysore -> Tamil Nadu, 1973 C. Orissa -> Odisha, 2000 D. Pondicherry -> Lakshadweep, 2006

Answer: A.

- **A:** Correct: United Provinces was renamed Uttar Pradesh in 1950.
- **B:** Madras became Tamil Nadu in 1969, not 1973.
- **C:** Mysore became Karnataka in 1973, not 1969.
- **D:** Orissa became Odisha in 2011, not 2006.

Examiner trap: Renaming years are designed for swaps: Tamil Nadu 1969, Karnataka 1973, Odisha 2011.

Q26. The enacted result of the 1956 settlement was

A. 16 States and 3 UTs B. 14 States and 6 UTs C. 28 States and 8 UTs D. 9 Part A and 9 Part B States

Answer: B.

- **A:** Sixteen States and three UTs is not the enacted 1956 count.
- **B:** Correct: the 1956 Act and Seventh Amendment produced 14 States and 6 Union Territories and ended the Part A-B-C-D structure.
- **C:** Twenty-eight States and eight UTs is the current post-2020 count, not the 1956 settlement.
- **D:** Nine Part A and nine Part B units describe part of the 1950 transitional classification.

Examiner trap: Do not confuse the Commission's recommendations with the enacted 1956 map.

Q27. Which statement is correct about Ladakh's current demand?

A. Statehood was granted by the PIB release of September 2025 B. Sixth Schedule status automatically followed the 2025 regulations C. Official PIB releases recorded Statehood/Sixth-Schedule demands and continuing safeguard dialogue, but no territorial-status change D. Ladakh became a State through the 100th Amendment

Answer: C.

- **A:** A political demand does not itself amend the First Schedule.
- **B:** The 2023 judgment did not create Ladakh Statehood.
- **C:** Correct: Statehood or constitutional-protection demands remain political claims unless translated into operative constitutional or statutory change.
- **D:** The Article 3 proviso does not give a UT legislature a constitutional veto.

Examiner trap: Demand, negotiation, Bill, enactment and commencement are five different legal statuses.

Q28. Which statement best explains why Article 3 is often cited as proof of India's strong-Centre bias?

A. States cannot legislate on the Concurrent List B. every State law needs Presidential approval C. Rajya Sabha seats are equal across States D. Parliament may reorganise States without needing their consent

Answer: D.

- **A:** Article 3 does not abolish the constitutional distribution of powers.
- **B:** The President cannot reorganise States by personal decree; Parliament must enact the law.
- **C:** A State legislature is consulted, but it cannot block the measure.
- **D:** Correct: Parliament may alter a State's area, boundary or name without its consent, showing pronounced central power over the internal map.

Examiner trap: Strong-Centre bias here means control of territorial identity, not absence of federalism.

Q29. Article 4 expressly enables a law under Articles 2 or 3 to amend which Schedules as necessary?

A. The First and Fourth Schedules B. The Fifth and Sixth Schedules C. The Seventh and Eighth Schedules D. The Ninth and Tenth Schedules

Answer: A.

- **A:** Correct: Article 4 expressly permits consequential amendment of the First and Fourth Schedules.
- **B:** The Fifth and Sixth Schedules concern scheduled and tribal-area governance.
- **C:** The Seventh distributes legislative subjects and the Eighth lists recognised languages.
- **D:** The Ninth and Tenth Schedules concern protected laws and anti-defection, not Article 4's express pair.

Examiner trap: Article 4's express schedule pair is First + Fourth.

Q30. Parliament materially amends an Article 3 Bill after the affected State legislature has sent its views. Which statement is correct?

A. The Bill automatically lapses B. A fresh State-legislature reference is not constitutionally required for every amendment C. The State legislature acquires a veto over the amended clauses D. The Supreme Court must approve the amended Bill before passage

Answer: B.

- **A:** Parliamentary alteration after consultation does not automatically lapse the Bill.
- **B:** Correct: the Constitution does not require a fresh State-legislature reference for every parliamentary amendment.
- **C:** The affected State never acquires a veto over the original or amended proposal.
- **D:** Pre-enactment Supreme Court approval is not an Article 3 procedural condition.

Examiner trap: The State comments on the referred proposal; it does not co-draft every parliamentary amendment.

Q31. Historical polity texts list conquest among modes of territorial acquisition. A current answer should add that

A. conquest remains unrestricted whenever Parliament passes an Article 3 law B. the President may validate acquisition by ordinance C. contemporary international law and the UN Charter sharply constrain acquisition by force D. acquired territory must immediately become a full State

Answer: C.

- **A:** Article 3 cannot legalise forcible external acquisition, and modern international law rejects conquest as an unrestricted title.
- **B:** A presidential ordinance cannot cure an unlawful use of force or settle sovereign title by itself.
- **C:** Correct: historical textbook lists must be qualified by the UN Charter prohibition on aggressive territorial acquisition.

- **D:** Article 1 recognises acquired territory as distinct; it need not immediately become a full State.

Examiner trap: Historical modes of acquisition must be filtered through contemporary international law.

Q32. State of West Bengal v. Union of India is relevant to this topic chiefly because it

A. created Andhra State B. authorised foreign cession under Article 3 C. made State consent compulsory D. supports the strong-Centre proposition that Indian States are not classical compact-sovereigns

Answer: D.

- **A:** The case did not require State consent for Article 3 reorganisation.
- **B:** It was not the controlling foreign-cession ruling; *Berubari* fills that role.
- **C:** It did not make India a treaty federation.
- **D:** Correct: it denied classical coordinate sovereignty to States and supports the strong-Union background of territorial federalism.

Examiner trap: Use *West Bengal v Union* for State sovereignty status, not as a substitute for Article 3 or *Berubari*.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Audited ownership and key discipline

Item	Status	Key treatment
UPSC Prelims 2025 GS-I Q52	Exact wording verified from the local official Set-A paper	Official local Set-A key: C
UPSC Mains 2018 GS-I Q12	Exact wording retained from the audited routing ledger/source owner	No objective key involved
UPSC Mains 2022 GS-I Q11	Exact wording retained from the audited routing ledger/source owner	No objective key involved

No other directly routed Topic 5 PYQ was located in the audited 2018-2026 repository ledgers. Detailed J&K/Delhi legislature-power questions remain with Topic 25.

PYQ 1. Prelims 2025, GS Paper I, Question 52 - verbatim official-paper verification

Consider the following pairs:

State	Description
I. Arunachal Pradesh	The capital is named after a fort, and the State has two National Parks
II. Nagaland	The State came into existence on the basis of a Constitutional Amendment Act
III. Tripura	Initially a Part 'C' State, it became a centrally administered territory with the reorganization of States in 1956 and later attained the status of a full-fledged State

How many of the above pairs are correctly matched?

(a) Only one (b) Only two (c) All the three (d) None

Official Set-A answer: (c) All the three.

- **Pair I:** Itanagar is named after Ita Fort; Arunachal Pradesh has Namdapha and Mouling National Parks.
- **Pair II:** The official key accepts the pair. Nagaland's settlement involved the State of Nagaland Act, 1962 and the Constitution (Thirteenth Amendment) Act, 1962, which inserted Article 371A.
- **Pair III:** Tripura was a Part C unit, became a Union Territory in the 1956 arrangement and attained full Statehood in 1972.

Why this earns marks: it follows the official key, tests every pair independently, and explains why

How to improve this answer: Reproduce the three-pair logic, distinguish Nagaland's Statehood Act from the accompanying Thirteenth Amendment, and explicitly anchor the result to the official UPSC key.

an ordinary Statehood Act and an accompanying constitutional amendment are not mutually exclusive.

PYQ 2. Mains 2018, GS Paper I, Question 12 - owner-verified exact text

Question: Discuss whether formation of new states in recent times is beneficial or not for the economy of India. (15 marks, 250 words)

Model solution

State formation can improve economic governance, but the gain follows from **institutional capacity and transition design**, not from small size by itself.

Potential benefits. A smaller unit can reduce administrative distance, reveal region-specific constraints and align budgets with local geography. **Chhattisgarh** obtained a dedicated policy arena for a large tribal-mineral region; **Uttarakhand** could focus on mountain roads, tourism and disaster risk; **Jharkhand** acquired a separate budgetary platform for mineral-rich but socially deprived districts; **Telangana** gained autonomous policy priority after 2014. These cases show how Statehood can improve problem recognition, accountability and capital allocation.

Costs and qualifications. New capitals, High Courts, cadres and departments create large fixed costs. Weak revenue capacity may increase grant dependence. Division of debt, employees, institutions, power and river water can generate prolonged disputes: the **Andhra Pradesh-Telangana** transition illustrates capital, asset and water frictions. Statehood also did not automatically remove **Jharkhand's political instability**, while Uttarakhand's development model remains constrained by fragile Himalayan ecology.

Thus, the relevant test is not "smaller equals richer" but whether reorganisation corrects neglect, improves access and is supported by viable finances, accountable institutions and a negotiated transition. New States can be economically beneficial, but Article 3 is a constitutional instrument, not a self-executing development policy.

Why this earns marks: the answer follows the economic directive, uses four named State examples,

How to improve this answer: Use the exact economic demand, organise gains and costs under capacity, fiscal viability and transition, and add a measurable indicator rather than assuming smallness proves benefit.

links each example to a mechanism, presents transition costs and ends with a conditional verdict.

PYQ 3. Mains 2022, GS Paper I, Question 11 - owner-verified exact text

Question: The political and administrative reorganization of states and territories has been a continuous ongoing process since the mid-nineteenth century. Discuss with examples. (15 marks, 250 words)

Model solution

India's political map has never been static; it has been repeatedly remade by colonial administration, national integration, linguistic accommodation, security settlements and developmental demands.

Colonial phase. The **1858 Crown takeover**, later provincial adjustments and the **1905 partition and 1911 reunification of Bengal** showed that boundaries could be administrative instruments with large political consequences. The Government of India Acts also altered provincial structures and degrees of autonomy.

Integration and transition. After 1947, accession and merger integrated princely States through different routes: **Junagadh, Hyderabad and Jammu and Kashmir** demonstrate plebiscitary, coercive and accession-under-invasion complexities. The 1950 **Part A/B/C/D** classification was therefore a transitional constitutional map, not a final settlement.

Linguistic and later reorganisation. **Andhra (1953)** made language unavoidable. The **Fazl Ali Commission**, while rejecting "one language-one State", led to the **States Reorganisation Act, 1956 and Seventh Amendment**, creating 14 States and 6 UTs. Later changes responded to multiple drivers: Maharashtra-Gujarat (1960), Nagaland (1963), Haryana (1966), North-Eastern Statehood (1972 and 1987), Sikkim (1975), the three States of 2000, Telangana (2014), J&K-Ladakh (2019) and the DNH-DD UT merger (2020).

The continuity lies in the recurring search for congruence between identity, administrative viability and national unity. Article 3 constitutionalised that adaptability, though democratic legitimacy still depends on consultation and fair transition.

Why this earns marks: it respects the mid-nineteenth-century time span, uses chronology as analysis,

How to improve this answer: Open with a mid-nineteenth/colonial boundary example, then structure colonial, integration, linguistic and post-1956 phases so continuity is demonstrated across the full period.

names examples across every phase and closes by identifying the continuing constitutional mechanism.

Six original Mains questions with complete model solutions

Original Mains model 1 - 10 marks: Distinguish the 'Territory of India' from the 'Union of India'. Why does the distinction matter?

Model answer. [CLAIM] The two expressions are related but not identical. [EVIDENCE] Article 1 and standard polity doctrine treat the Union of India as the States taken as federal members, whereas the Territory of India includes the territories of the States, the Union Territories, and such territories as may be acquired. [MECHANISM] This matters because States share constitutionally distributed powers with the Union, while Union Territories are centrally administered units under Articles 239-241 and acquired territories may await internal constitutional placement. [ANALYSIS] The distinction explains why a UT belongs to India without becoming a full federal partner, and why the First Schedule can list both States and UTs while still preserving their unequal constitutional status. [LIMIT] The distinction is structural, not emotional; one should not collapse sovereignty with federal membership. [VERDICT] The Union of India is the federation's membership core; the Territory of India is the wider constitutional space over which Indian sovereignty extends. **Why this earns marks:** it defines both expressions, links them to operative constitutional consequences, and avoids the common synonym trap.

How to improve this answer: Add a compact Union-versus-Territory table and one First-Schedule consequence while keeping detailed UT administration outside this topic.

Original Mains model 2 - 10 marks: Distinguish cession of Indian territory from settlement of a boundary dispute.

Model answer. [CLAIM] The Constitution treats cession and boundary settlement differently because only the former parts with accepted sovereign territory. [EVIDENCE] *Berubari Union (1960)* held that ceding accepted Indian territory to a foreign State cannot be done under Article 3 and requires constitutional amendment under Article 368. [MECHANISM] Cession changes the sovereign content of the Constitution's territorial ledger. By contrast, the Supreme Court's later 1969 ruling held that where the issue is ascertainment or implementation of an existing disputed boundary, and not transfer of accepted Indian territory, executive action need not be preceded by Article 368. [ANALYSIS] The test is not whether another country is involved, but whether India is surrendering what it accepts as its own territory. [LIMIT] A boundary-settlement label cannot disguise actual cession. [VERDICT] Cession changes sovereignty and needs amendment; boundary settlement clarifies or implements an existing line and need not. **Why this earns marks:** it identifies the controlling test, uses the safely verified case/principle and converts the distinction into a usable constitutional rule.

How to improve this answer: State the accepted-territory test and sequence *Berubari Union (1960)*, *Maganbhai* and the 100th Amendment without implying that the Ninth Amendment completed every contemplated transfer.

Original Mains model 3 - 15 marks: 'India is an indestructible Union of destructible States.'
Examine with special reference to Article 3.

Model answer. [CLAIM] The phrase captures the asymmetry built into Indian federalism: the Union's continuity is entrenched, but State boundaries are not. [EVIDENCE] Article 1 names India a Union of States, while Article 3 empowers Parliament to form new States, increase or diminish their area, alter boundaries and alter names. [MECHANISM] An Article 3 bill requires the President's prior recommendation and reference to the affected State legislature for views, but those views are non-binding. Article 4 then keeps the reorganisation law outside Article 368, allowing ordinary-majority change. [ANALYSIS] This makes the Indian federation unlike a compact federation such as the United States, where State consent is structurally stronger. Yet the same flexibility enabled linguistic reorganisation, small-State creation and administrative adaptation without constitutional deadlock. [EVIDENCE] Andhra (1953), the 1956 settlement, and later creations such as Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand and Telangana show the practical utility of this power. [LIMIT] The design can create a democratic-consent deficit when major territorial change proceeds over sharp regional opposition. [VERDICT] India is indestructible because no State can claim a right to continued boundaries or secession; the States are destructible only in the constitutional sense that Parliament may reorganise them, not in the sense of lawless central arbitrariness. **Why this earns marks:** it ties the famous formula to the exact procedural mechanics of Article 3 and balances national flexibility with federal criticism.

How to improve this answer: List the Article 3 operations and UT/proviso nuance precisely, then use only a short qualified comparative-federalism contrast tied to consent.

Original Mains model 4 - 15 marks: Demands for smaller States should be decided through governance criteria, not identity alone. Discuss.

Model answer. [CLAIM] Identity can establish democratic urgency, but it cannot by itself prove that a new State will govern better. [EVIDENCE] Uttarakhand, Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand were created in 2000 to address distinct regional geographies and developmental claims; Telangana followed in 2014 after sustained regional mobilisation. [ANALYSIS] Smaller units may improve administrative access, policy focus and accountability. [QUALIFICATION] Statehood also creates new capital, cadre and institutional costs; weak revenue bases can deepen grant dependence; water, power, debt and assets can generate inter-State disputes; and a new regional majority may create a new minority. Jharkhand's institutional instability and Andhra-Telangana transition disputes show that Statehood is not a self-executing development policy. [CURRENT EVIDENCE] J&K restoration remains a law-versus-assurance test: the Supreme Court urged early restoration, but the official-source check located no operative restoration law or appointed-day notification through 7 September 2026. [VERDICT] Parliament should use Article 3 after transparent viability studies, broad consultation and negotiated transition, treating Statehood as a governance instrument rather than a reward for mobilisation. **Why this earns marks:** it uses four named examples, connects each claim to a mechanism, includes present debates and supplies operational decision criteria.

How to improve this answer: Turn the criteria into an ex-ante decision matrix and add one ex-post counterexample showing why identity or size alone cannot guarantee capacity.

Original Mains model 5 - 20 marks: Linguistic reorganisation strengthened rather than weakened the Indian Union. Critically examine.

Model answer. [CLAIM] Linguistic reorganisation ultimately strengthened the Indian Union because it channelled identity into constitutional politics rather than leaving it outside the system, though not without centralising tensions and new sub-regional claims. [EVIDENCE] The initial hesitation of the Dhar Commission and the JVP Committee reflected a real fear that language-based States might embolden fragmentation. The creation of Andhra in 1953 after Potti Sriramulu's death showed that these demands could not simply be suppressed. [EVIDENCE] The Fazl Ali / States Reorganisation Commission accepted language as a major organising principle but rejected one language-one State and balanced it with viability, unity and welfare. The resulting States Reorganisation Act, 1956 and Seventh Amendment restructured India without dismantling its constitutional framework. [MECHANISM] By aligning administration with language in many cases, the Union reduced alienation, improved representational legitimacy and absorbed regional mobilisation into parliamentary and electoral channels. [ANALYSIS] Later developments - Nagaland, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Goa, Telangana and smaller-State formations in 2000 - show that Article 3 remained an accommodation device, not merely a linguistic tool. [LIMIT] Reorganisation did not end regionalism; it often displaced it into fresh internal claims for smaller units, capitals or autonomous protections. Nor can every present-day

demand be justified by language alone. [VERDICT] Linguistic reorganisation did not dissolve the Union; it made the Union governable by recognising identity inside the Constitution. Its success, however, depended on combining language with viability, asymmetry and central constitutional control. **Why this earns marks:** it uses chronology as argument, gives both the fear and the outcome, and converts the 1956 settlement into a broader federalism verdict.

How to improve this answer: Create a separate criticism paragraph on sub-regionalism, capitals and minority protection, then return to the SRC's multi-factor test for the final verdict.

Original Mains model 6 - 20 marks: Does Article 3 reconcile national unity with democratic consent, or does it privilege unity at the expense of federal trust? Critically examine.

Model answer. [CLAIM] Article 3 reconciles unity and democracy only partially: it was designed to privilege the Union's continuity, and democratic consent enters the structure as consultation rather than as a State veto. [EVIDENCE] The President must recommend the bill and refer it to the affected State legislature for views, but Parliament is not bound by those views. Article 4 then keeps the resulting law outside Article 368, reinforcing flexibility. [MECHANISM] This makes Article 3 a nation-preserving safety valve. The Union can respond to secessionary pressures, viability problems, linguistic claims and administrative demands without constitutional paralysis. Andhra, the 1956 settlement, State creation in 2000 and Telangana in 2014 are evidence of this accommodative capacity. [ANALYSIS] Yet the same structure can weaken trust. If an affected State's legislature can only advise and not co-decide, consultation may appear symbolic in politically high-stakes reorganisations. The conversion of a former State into Union Territories in 2019 intensified this anxiety. [EVIDENCE] *State of West Bengal v Union of India* reinforces the strong-Centre reading, while the continuing democratic force of federalism is better captured by the political need for negotiated legitimacy and, in the broader constitutional order, by *Bommai's* basic-feature floor. [LIMIT] A compact-federation standard is not fully appropriate for India, whose Constitution deliberately rejected a treaty-union model. [VERDICT] Article 3 does not produce symmetrical federal consent; it privileges unity structurally, but can still generate democratic legitimacy when used through negotiation, transparency and accommodation rather than through bare majoritarian power. **Why this earns marks:** it neither romanticises consent nor demonises unity, and it uses the text, history and case law to produce a graded verdict rather than a slogan.

How to improve this answer: Separate validity, legitimacy and prudence; state the 2023 holding precisely-Ladakh upheld, whole-State-to-UT conversion not finally decided-and propose stronger consultation.